

Philipp Hilbert. *Senior Product Manager scaling SMB formation platforms.*

Positioning, I build 0-to-1 products for small business users and automate the operational workflows behind them, which is exactly what this role calls for.

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§ WHY FORBES ADVISOR

Forbes Advisor's formation platform sits at a interesting intersection: a high-consideration decision for a first-time business owner, a complex operational backend, and a content and SEO flywheel that can feed the funnel at scale. The brief to own new service offerings from hypothesis through scaled launch, and to automate core operational workflows to reduce unit costs, is the kind of scope I have done well with before. The specific challenge of making a regulated, multi-step process feel simple to a solopreneur who has never formed a company before is one I find compelling.

That is the problem I want to work on next.

§ AI-NATIVE STACK

Daily tools, not buzzwords.

- **Claude Code**, in-repo refactors and spec generation
- **Cursor / VSCode**, LLM-assisted development
- **GitHub Copilot**, paired development
- **Lovable**, rapid front-end prototyping
- **Framer**, design-heavy prototyping
- **n8n**, agentic workflow automation

- **Gamma.app**, stakeholder presentations
 - **GPT**, research, edge-case generation
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§ TECHNICAL ENVIRONMENT

Shipped with, not just listed.

PostgreSQL, SQL, Dagster, dbt, REST APIs, Python, Kotlin (Spring Boot), Kafka, MongoDB, Kubernetes, Docker, ArgoCD, GitOps, Jenkins, CI/CD, Git, Azure DevOps, Jira, Confluence, Figma, Miro, Matomo, MicroStrategy.

§ SIDE PROJECT

CONSTRUCT8 [GITHUB.COM/HILBERTP](https://github.com/HilbertP) →

Two-sided B2B marketplace connecting construction firms with workers, zero to one, built alone.

- Anonymity-until-payment model protects both sides until commitment is made.
 - WhatsApp and Telegram as the product surface, keeping acquisition costs near zero.
 - LLM agents across the funnel so a single operator can run day-to-day operations.
 - Funnel and conversion analysis in SQL, the same analytics discipline this role needs for post-launch iteration.
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§ HOW I WOULD WORK AT FORBES ADVISOR

First weeks, concrete.

WEEK 1

Listen, map, find the gaps.

I shadow the formation and case-management workflows end to end, talk to ops, support, and whoever owns the current automation layer, and map where handoffs break and where unit costs are highest.

WEEK 2

Identify first slice.

I bring one concrete automation or workflow improvement to the table with a clear before/after metric, scoped small enough to ship in a sprint and validate the approach.

WEEK 3+

Ship, measure, repeat.

I run the first increment through delivery, instrument the outcome metric, and use the findings to sequence the next item on the backlog, building the cadence the team will carry forward.

I COVER LETTER

Dear Forbes Advisor team,

I have spent 13 years shipping products in regulated, operationally complex environments, insurance, public-sector data platforms, healthcare, and fintech. At EMIL Group I took the Claims Center from concept to production and cut the time to launch a new insurance product from months to under a week. At Bundesagentur für Arbeit I automated quarterly data imports with Dagster and dbt, cutting the time per data update by roughly 75%. These were not isolated wins. They came from the same pattern this role asks for: map the operational workflow, find where friction concentrates, and build the thing that removes it.

The formation and management platform you are building sits in a space I find interesting. Small business owners forming their first company are making one of the highest-stakes decisions of their professional lives, but they are doing it with limited time, limited legal fluency, and low tolerance for complexity. Building a product that makes that process feel straightforward, while automating the backend workflows that make it economical to serve them, is a hard problem worth solving.

The 0-to-1 brief resonates in particular. At construct8, my own two-sided marketplace, I went from blank page to a live product alone: anonymity-until-payment model, LLM agents across the funnel, WhatsApp and Telegram as the product surface, and SQL for funnel analysis. At Kvitt Payment Solutions I took a P2P payments product from zero to acquisition by Sparkasse, operating inside the girocard ecosystem. I know what it takes to move from hypothesis to customer validation to scaled launch, and I know the places where founders typically slow down or build the wrong thing.

On the data side I am comfortable in SQL and have owned analytics instrumentation across multiple platforms, from funnel and churn analysis to KPI definition and post-launch iteration loops. I have used Figma for prototyping across stakeholders and Amplitude-equivalent tools for product analytics. I am also an active builder with AI-native tooling: I use Claude Code, Cursor, n8n, and Lovable daily, and I have designed and shipped agentic workflows that run with minimal human intervention.

I would welcome the chance to talk through the formation platform's current priorities and where I could make the biggest difference in the first quarter.

Best regards, *Philipp Hilbert*

II CURRICULUM VITAE

§ PROFILE

Senior Product Manager with 13 years of product ownership, specialising in platform products for SMBs, insurance, payments, and public-sector data. I run continuous discovery, translate user needs and technical constraints into a prioritised roadmap, and lead cross-functional teams through agile delivery. I have shipped 0-to-1 products, automated core operational workflows, and owned SQL-based analytics across the full product lifecycle.

§ HOW I WORK

- I leave my ego at home. I want to drive the decision, not to have the last word.
 - On a new product I spend a little to learn before spending a lot to build. Cheap experiments make expensive decisions safe(r).
 - Outcome over output. Producing something is not the achievement; it also has to fit a market, so I agree what would count as success before we build and check afterwards whether it happened.
 - I keep the whole value chain in view, not just the backlog. Defect-to-fix time is a product metric; architects and DevOps engineers build that chain, my job is to steer it into the right lanes.
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§ WORK EXPERIENCE

PRODUCT MANAGER, ROHDE & SCHWARZ, MUNICH / REMOTE | 07/2024 - 05/2025

Defence and aerospace. Internal AI and data platform for the FCAS European programme.

- Spearheaded development of the internal AI and data platform for the FCAS European programme, managing a cross-functional team of 15+ engineers and data scientists through Scrum in Jira and Confluence.
- Redirected product strategy based on user workflow analysis, increasing pipeline runs by 200% by prioritising developer-code-first over UI-led design.

- Championed GitOps delivery with ArgoCD, reducing rollout time from days to 30 minutes and making the platform hotfix-capable.

PRODUCT MANAGER, BUNDESAGENTUR FÜR ARBEIT (FEDERAL EMPLOYMENT AGENCY), NUREMBERG / REMOTE | 05/2023 - 07/2024

Public sector. National labour-market analytics platform for policymakers and researchers. Deputy IT Security Officer.

- Introduced Dagster and dbt so quarterly imports and new indicators ran without hand-holding, saving almost 75% of the time per data update.
- Integrated test automation into the Jenkins pipeline and freed several QA hours every week.
- Migrated a bare-metal system fully into containers and carried a full UI relaunch and a large ETL migration through the same period.

PRODUCT MANAGER, EMIL GROUP, BERLIN | 04/2022 - 12/2022

Insurance. B2B SaaS platform for insurers, reinsurers, brokers and underwriters.

- Shipped the Claims Center from concept to production with no precedent, and cut time-to-market for launching a new insurance product from months to less than a week.
- Restructured an 18-person delivery organisation into three lean teams: attrition fell from a near-total exodus to a single departure.

PRODUCT OWNER, CLINET PLATFORMS, BERLIN | 01/2023 - 07/2023

Healthcare. Mobile patient app for iOS and Android, piloted in hospitals.

- Cut a roadmap that a five-person team could not deliver to the top 10% of features: user acceptance rose more than fivefold.
- Implemented the CGM interface into hospital KIS workflows, reducing digital anamnesis time from 30 minutes to 5.

PRODUCT OWNER INTEGRATION TEAM, SCHEIDT & BACHMANN FUEL & CONVENIENCE RETAIL, MÖNCHENGLADBACH | 09/2021 - 03/2022

Retail and payments. POS and forecourt systems.

- Moved research results into production across a matrix organisation in a fully SAFe setup with agile release trains and PI planning.

PRODUCT OWNER (INTERIM), BUNDESDRUCKEREI, BERLIN | 03/2021 - 06/2021

Government. Secure data platform for the Robert Koch Institute programmes DIM and DESH.

- Owned data structures and identity management in a high-sensitivity government context.

PRODUCT OWNER (PROXY), AOK ITSCARE, FRANKFURT | 03/2019 - 05/2020

Health insurance. B2B procurement webshop.

- Migrated a legacy system to Shopware for three AOK insurers and roughly 20,000 employees; still in production.
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§ FOUNDER TRACK

FOUNDER AND PRODUCT MANAGER, CONSTRUCT8, LIMASSOL | 12/2025 - 06/2026

Construction staffing. Two-sided B2B marketplace matching firms with workers.

- Built zero to one alone: anonymity-until-payment model, LLM agents across the funnel, WhatsApp and Telegram as product surface, SQL for funnel and conversion analysis.

CO-FOUNDER AND PRODUCT OWNER, QCRYPT AG, BERLIN | 01/2016 - 12/2021

IT security. Quantum-secure encryption hardware and software.

- Shipped a three-layer product that installs in under two minutes; enterprise buyers required it. Later Chair of the board.

FOUNDER AND CFO, KVITT PAYMENT SOLUTIONS, BERLIN | 02/2013 - 11/2018

Fintech. Mobile group-based P2P payments.

- Built from zero and taken to acquisition: acquired and operated by Sparkasse inside the girocard ecosystem.
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§ SKILLS

Product Management: continuous discovery, product vision and product roadmap, 0-to-1 product development, MVP (minimum viable product) definition, PoC (proof of concept), prioritisation, user research and interviews, A/B testing, prototyping (Figma, Lovable, Framer), go-to-market support, product lifecycle management.

Analytics and Data: SQL, funnel and churn analysis, KPI (key performance indicator) definition, ETL (extract, transform, load), Dagster, dbt (data build tool), PostgreSQL, Matomo, MicroStrategy.

Product Ownership: requirements engineering, user stories, acceptance criteria, backlog refinement, sprint planning, velocity and burndown, UAT (user acceptance testing), Jira, Confluence.

Agile and Scaled Delivery: Scrum, Kanban, SAgile (Scaled Agile Framework), ART (agile release train), PI (program increment) planning.

AI Products and Tooling: LLM agents, agentic workflows, prompt and context engineering, human-in-the-loop design, EU AI Act; Claude Code, GitHub Copilot, Cursor, Lovable, n8n.

Stakeholder and Leadership: cross-functional team leadership, C-level reporting, workshop facilitation, conflict resolution, change management.

Technical Environments Owned: Kubernetes, Docker, ArgoCD, GitOps, CI/CD, Jenkins, REST APIs, Python, SQL, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Kafka.

Governance: GDPR (General Data Protection Regulation), Deputy IT Security Officer, identity management, budget ownership and financial planning.

§ EDUCATION

DIPLOM-WIRTSCHAFTSINGENIEUR (INDUSTRIAL ENGINEERING AND MANAGEMENT, EQUIVALENT TO A MASTER'S DEGREE), TECHNISCHE UNIVERSITÄT BERLIN (TU BERLIN), GERMANY | 10/2006 - 09/2014

- Specialisation: Logistics. Thesis with Siemens AG Energy Service on balancing-power market profitability.

§ LANGUAGES

German (native speaker, C2) · English (C2, business and technical fluency)

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